Chili Con Carne Tortilla Bites

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

These baked tortilla bites have become a staple in our house.

Serves 6–8 · Prep 20 min · Cook 40 min

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE CHILI CON CARNE

- 3 tbsp olive oil
- 1 cup grated onion
- 1 tsp salt, adjusted to taste
- 500 g minced beef
- 1 tbsp ground cumin
- 1 cup diced capsicum
- 1 tbsp smoked paprika
- 1 tbsp dried oregano
- 2 tbsp tomato paste
- 2 tbsp barbecue sauce, optional
- 1 cup beef stock
- 2 cups canned chopped tomatoes

FOR THE TORTILLA CUPS

- Approximately 6 large soft flour tortillas
- Approximately 200 g shredded cheddar
- A little olive oil, for greasing

TO SERVE

- Sour cream *(optional)*
- Tomato salsa *(optional)*

METHOD

1. Prepare the chili. Heat the olive oil in a large, deep frying pan over medium heat. Add the grated onion and cook for approximately 5 minutes, until softened.
2. Add the minced beef and cook, breaking it up with a spoon, until browned. Stir in the salt, cumin, capsicum, smoked paprika and oregano. Cook for another 2–3 minutes.
3. Stir in the tomato paste and cook for 1 minute. Add the barbecue sauce, if using, followed by the beef stock and canned tomatoes.
4. Bring to a simmer and cook uncovered for approximately 20–25 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the chili is thick and spoonable. Taste and adjust the seasoning.
5. Prepare the tortilla cups. While the chili simmers, preheat the oven to 180°C. Lightly grease two 12-hole standard muffin tins.
6. Cut the tortillas into approximately 12 cm rounds, using a small plate or cutter as a guide. You will need 24 rounds; the number of tortillas required will depend on their size. Gently press a round into each muffin hole, allowing the edges to form a cup.
7. Divide the thickened chili between the tortilla cups and sprinkle generously with shredded cheddar.
8. Bake for approximately 10–15 minutes, until the tortilla edges are golden and crisp and the cheese has melted.
9. Leave to settle for a few minutes before carefully lifting the cups out of the tins. Serve warm with sour cream and plenty of salsa.

Tip

Keep the filling thick. Simmer away excess liquid before filling the tortillas so the bases hold their shape.